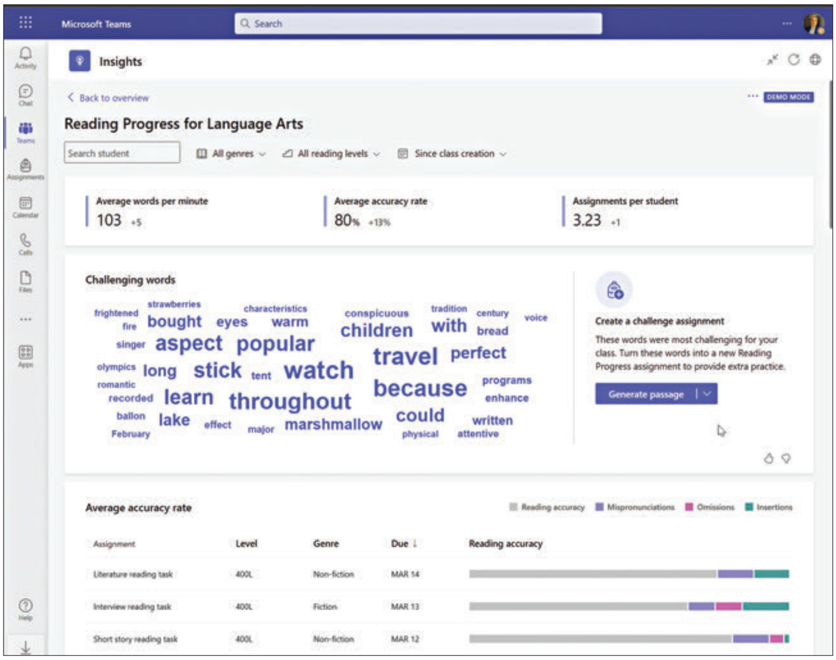

laptops come into the picture. By utilising their in-built algorithms, AI-powered laptops in academics can come up with solutions that will optimise the hardware allocation on the laptop whenever the user is running an intensive data processing task or program. They can open the gates for individuals to ensure that they do not have to rely on getting their time with a capable enough machine at their institute to get their work done. This will not only aid individuals who cannot afford to have high-end hardware in their laptops to expand their horizons, but they will also let individuals running underpowered machines to increase the efficiency of their workflow.

Easy and quick assessments and solutions to problems

This is a two-pronged benefit of having AI-powered laptops in academics. Utilising laptops with the capability to run AI applications natively can not only help educators streamline their assessment but can also help students get easier and quicker solutions to their problems via virtual tutors, enabling them to get answers to their questions at any time.

Virtual tutors are already being deployed across the world, so adapting them for Indian applications with the increasing influx of AI-powered laptops in academics will foster a better learning environment for students. In a statement by the United Arab Emirates Ministry of Education published by Microsoft, it was stated that the nation's government is already working towards using AI-enabled virtual tutors as a part of their education system. It read –

"The future holds numerous opportunities and challenges, and as a Ministry of Education, we are keen to benefit from the opportunities and confront any challenges. We believe that integrating AI within our educational system and harnessing modern and cutting-edge technologies is key to improving the quality of education and equipping our future leaders with the skills they need to flourish in an ever-evolving world. Our partnership with Microsoft to build an AI tutor is another step in our ongoing efforts to enhance the learning experience of our students. We will continue working shoulder to shoulder with our partners to contribute to driving the future of education."

Coming to the topic of streamlined assessment processes for educators, a research study published by Thomas B. Fordham Institute stated, "Teachers spend about 11 hours a week grading assignments". Now, suppose these professors have access to AI-powered

Hallucin[AI]tion

For a couple of years now, we've been considering coming out with an issue that would have a cover story written by an AI model. We've tried several things such as feeding a language model our own articles as reference in hopes of the model replicating our writing styles. Alas, the initial attempts were quite unsuccessful since preparing our own articles for ingestion was quite the challenge. As AI models improved over the years, we've revisited the concept over and over again in hopes of achieving what we had initially set out to do but something or the other would throw a spanner in the works.

In the early days, the challenge was about getting the models to work. Now that we have advanced models such as ChatGPT, that no longer remains the concern. A few lines of text is more than sufficient to get a rather detailed response from the service. Your initial prompts might not elicit an accurate response but a few brief conversations with the popular service from OpenAI is enough to finetune the way you craft your prompts. What then comes out can be quite an eye-opener. For those who've been paranoid about AI services taking over their jobs, it's enough to push you over the edge.

The first time I gave ChatGPT a try, I asked it to design a circuit for lighting up a few LEDs and providing an interface of sorts by which to manipulate the LEDs on said subject, then you'll realise that most of it is actually inaccurate. The article might have been put together from different sources online but there's no concept of fact checking to see whether said circuit would actually fire up.

ChatGPT is basically a ridiculously talented seamstress. The articles generated by AI models might sometimes come across as believable but might be completely made up with no actual basis backing it up. This is known as hallucination. And the current generation of AIs are quite prone to imagining all sorts of weird things that read well but aren't perceived quite as good. Google's Bard was very publicly a victim of this very phenomenon. And even stable diffusion models have had similar faux pas in recent times. One particular example that comes to mind is an AI picture generator being asked to draw salmon swimming up a river. What it generated was a bunch of slabs or fillets of salmon overlaid on top of a photo of a river. Little does the AI know that salmon fillets aren't exactly capable of 'swimming' in the first place.

Thousands of publishers world wide have started experimenting with using AI for generating text content. It makes perfect business sense. After all, AI text generator services are cheaper than human resources and can belt out content at a pace that humans simply cannot keep up with. The

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Mithun Mohandas
Managing Editor